17.8 Meningitis in Children

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • Mother says • "He is very irritable and vomiting." **Objective** • Baby: fontanelle bulging, high-pitched cry • Temperature 39 °C • Feeding poorly	**ACTUAL** **Decreased intracranial adaptive capacity** related to meningeal inflammation as evidenced by bulging fontanelle and high-pitched cry.	Neurological status stable.	• Give IV antibiotics without delay, as prescribed. • Watch level of consciousness, the fontanelle and head circumference. • Keep the room quiet and dim.	Stable: **goal met**.
Subjective • Mother says • "He is very hot." **Objective** • Temperature 39 °C • Flushed	**ACTUAL** **Hyperthermia** related to infection as evidenced by fever.	Afebrile within 48 hours.	• Give antipyretics by weight. • Watch the temperature. • Keep him hydrated.	Afebrile: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Bacterial meningitis	**RISK** **Risk for infection (to others)** as evidenced by risk factors: droplet transmission.	Infection not passed on to contacts.	• Droplet precautions as policy says. • Inform infection control. • Arrange prophylaxis for contacts as ordered.	No spread: **goal met**.